

Checklist:

Business Collaboration Checklist

Understand the context

- ☐ Recognize that strong product leaders and empowered product teams are necessary, but not sufficient.
- ☐ Acknowledge that product work happens within the broader company context.
- ☐ Understand that the CEO, executives, and other stakeholders matter to product success.

Build cross-business relationships

- ☐ Identify the key stakeholders outside the product.
- ☐ Establish strong working relationships with the rest of the business.
- ☐ Approach those relationships with sensitivity and nuance.
 - ☐ Avoid using the term “**stakeholder management.**”
 - ☐ Explain that this is not about *managing* people around product, but about working *with* peers across the business in a collaborative way.

Shift the team model

- ☐ Recognize when the company is still operating with feature teams.
- ☐ Help the organization transition toward empowered product teams.
- ☐ Keep the focus on serving customers in ways that also work for the business.

Change how the product works with the business

- ☐ Move from a subservient model to a collaborative model.
- ☐ Encourage shared problem-solving instead of top-down feature delivery.
- ☐ Reinforce collaboration as the default way of working.

Support executive mindset change

- ☐ Help senior executives rethink how they view product teams.
- ☐ Build confidence in teams made up of ordinary individuals doing extraordinary work together.
- ☐ Prepare leaders for the organizational implications of this shift.

Lead the transformation

- ☐ Recognize that this is a significant company-wide change.
- ☐ Discuss how the change affects the rest of the business.
- ☐ Guide the company through changes in mindset and responsibilities.
- ☐ Continue reinforcing the new collaborative model over time.